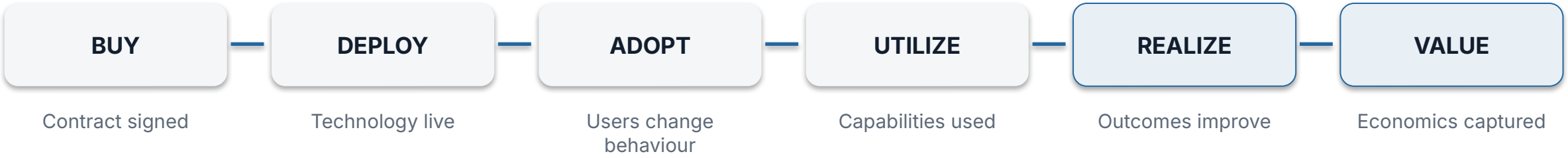
From Technology to Adoption, AI & Value

A practical playbook for presales professionals who sell outcomes — not features.

TECHNOLOGY | ADOPTION | UTILIZATION | AI | VALUE

Buying software is not realizing value.

Deployment is an event. Value is a system.



The presales question:

“What has to be true for the promised business value to actually materialize?”

The modern presales team needs more than product expertise.

SOLUTION ARCHITECT	FUNCTIONAL CONSULTANT	VALUE CONSULTANT	VALUE REALIZATION
Can we build it?	How should it work?	**Why does it matter?**	How will value be captured?

Your differentiation

Translate technology into adoption, utilization, measurable value and AI-enabled change.

Do not start with the product.

Start with the process. Find the leakage. Then connect technology.

01	**BUSINESS OBJECTIVE**	What are you trying to improve?
02	**CURRENT STATE**	How does it work today?
03	**VALUE LEAKAGE**	Where is time, money or quality lost?
04	**ROOT CAUSE**	Why does the leakage exist?
05	**SOLUTION**	What could technology change?

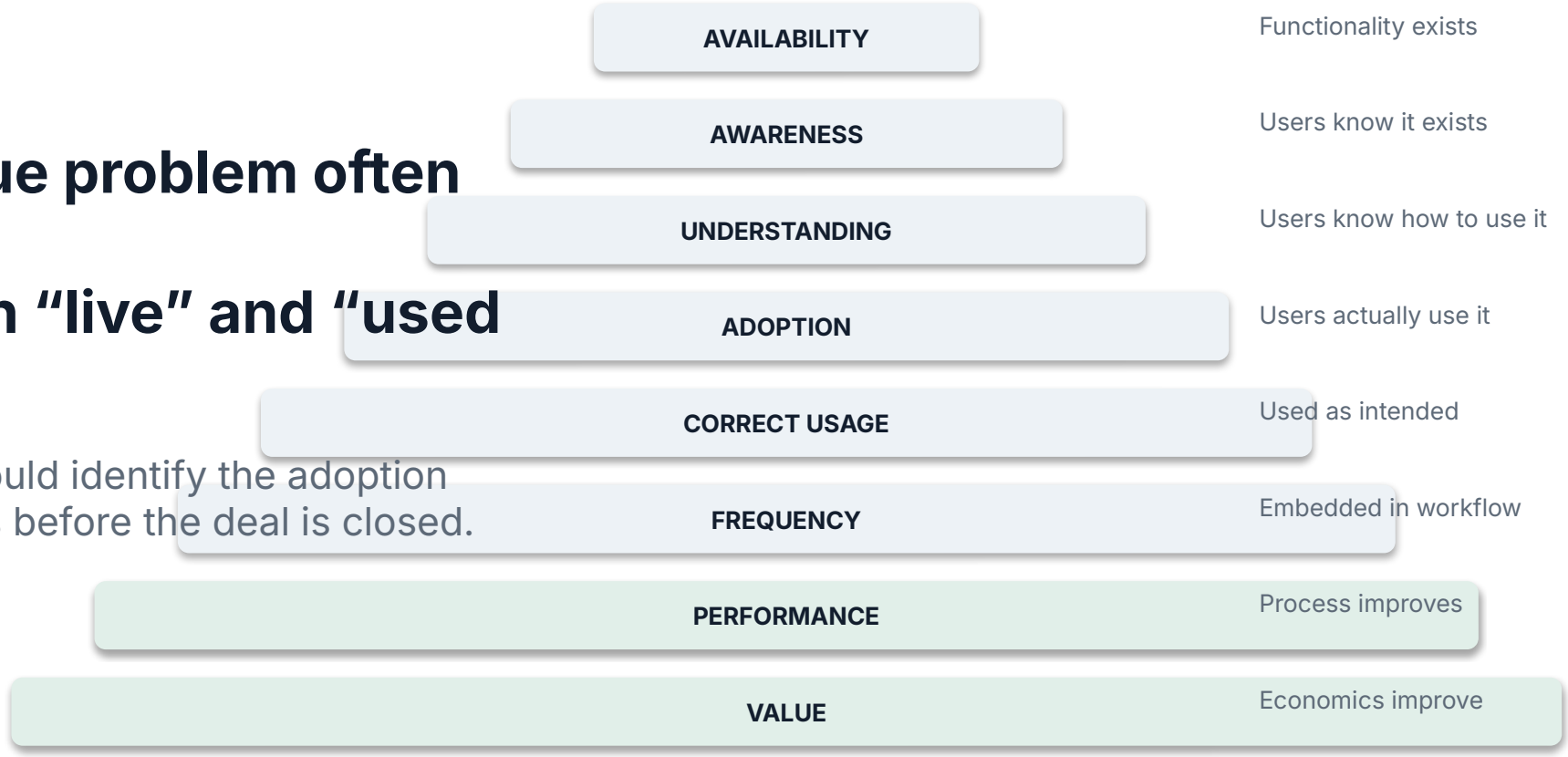
Deployment ≠ utilization.

A capability creates value only when behaviour changes.

KEY IDEA

The value problem often sits between “live” and “used well.”

Presales should identify the adoption assumptions before the deal is closed.



Where does SaaS value disappear?

FEATURE GAP

Capability doesn't match need

ADOPTION GAP

Users don't change behaviour

UTILIZATION GAP

Capabilities remain underused

PROCESS GAP

Old workarounds survive

DATA GAP

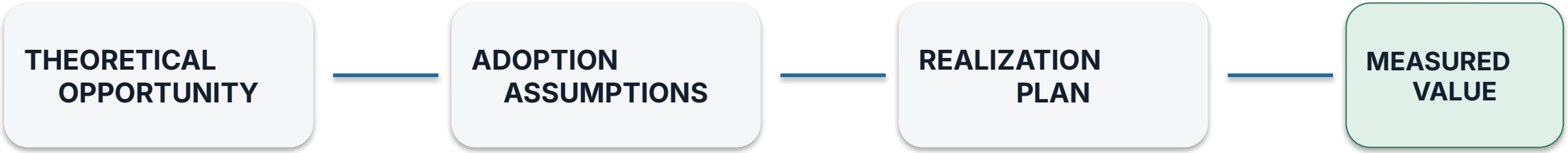
Inputs are incomplete or poor

GOVERNANCE GAP

Nobody owns the outcome

Diagnostic question: **“What is preventing the customer from capturing the value they already bought?”**

A business case is a hypothesis. Realization is the proof.



Value realization requires ownership, baseline measurement, behaviour change and a feedback loop.

Make the economics explicit.

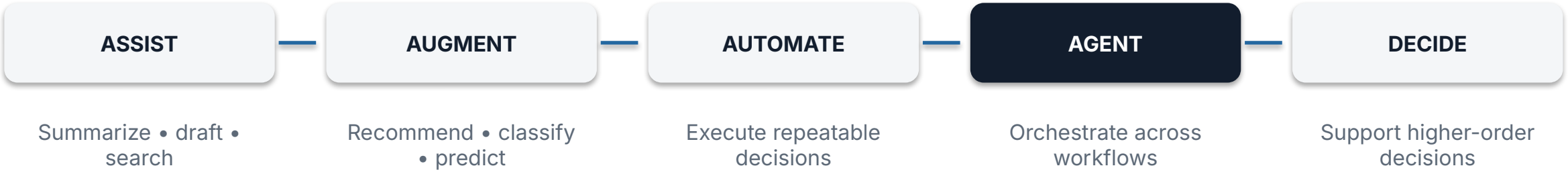
REALIZED VALUE =

BASELINE	× IMPROVEMENT	× ADOPTION	× REALIZATION
Current volume / cost / performance	Expected change	% of users / transactions using it	% of expected value actually captured

Example 100,000 invoices × €8 cost × 40% improvement × 60% adoption × 80% realization

= €153,600 realized annual value

AI should amplify the value equation — not decorate the pitch.



The discovery question

“What business decision or process do we want AI to improve?”

Not: “Where can we add AI?”

Five places to look for AI value.

SEARCH	**Too much information**	Retrieval, summarization
CLASSIFY	**Too many exceptions**	Routing, categorization
PREDICT	**Uncertain outcomes**	Forecasting, risk
RECOMMEND	**Complex decisions**	Next-best action
EXECUTE	**Repetitive workflows**	Automation, agents

AI value is strongest where the process already has volume, data and measurable friction.

Ask questions that expose economics, not features.

CFO

Where is cost or working capital leaking?

What financial KPI should move?

COO

Where does the process slow down?

What operational constraint matters most?

CIO

Where is complexity creating risk?

What must be standardized or simplified?

CHRO

Where is employee capacity constrained?

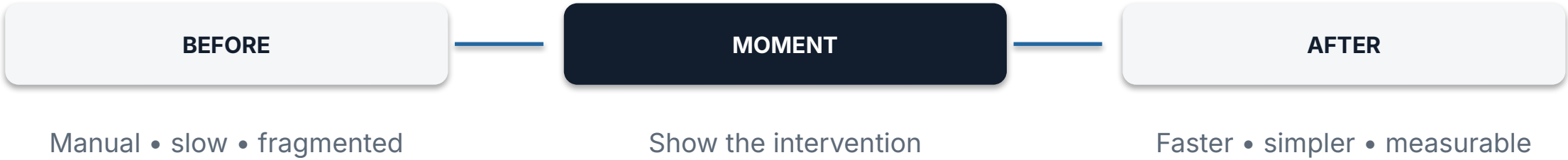
What work could be removed or redesigned?

CRO

Where is growth being lost?

Which part of the revenue engine is constrained?

Don't demonstrate features. Demonstrate changed outcomes.



Every demo should answer: **What changes? → Who benefits? → What KPI moves? → What is it worth?**

One page to connect discovery, solution and economics.

BUSINESS OBJECTIVE	SOLUTION	REALIZATION PLAN
CURRENT STATE	UTILIZATION	OWNER
VALUE LEAKAGE	AI OPPORTUNITY	KPI
ROOT CAUSE	VALUE	90-DAY PROOF

Use it live in discovery. Fill it with the customer's language.

From automation opportunity to realized value.

VOLUME	100k invoices / year
CURRENT COST	€8 / invoice
IMPROVEMENT	40%
ADOPTION	60%
REALIZATION	80%

€153.6k

realized annual value

Then ask:

- Who owns the outcome?
- What baseline will we measure?
- What must users do differently?
- How do we prove value in 90 days?

Turn “we want AI” into a value hypothesis.

CUSTOMER STATEMENT

“We want to use AI in customer service.”

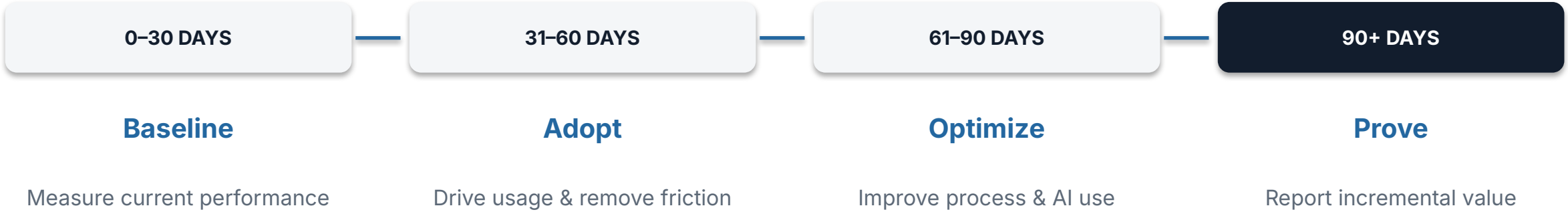
DISCOVERY

High ticket volume
Long handling time
Knowledge scattered
Many repeat questions

VALUE HYPOTHESIS

AI-assisted resolution
→ lower AHT
→ higher capacity
→ better CX

The deal should include the path to value.



A value realization plan converts a promise into an operating mechanism.

Bring the right people into the right conversation.

ACCOUNT / SALES	**VALUE**	**ARCHITECTURE**
Why change?	What is it worth?	Can we build it?
FUNCTIONAL	**AI**	**CUSTOMER SUCCESS**
How should it work?	How can intelligence amplify it?	How will it stick?

The strongest presales motion is cross-functional — but value needs an explicit owner.

Technology → Adoption → Utilization → AI → Value → Realization

The question is no longer:

“What can the software do?”

It is:

“What can the customer achieve — and what must happen for that value to be realized?”